DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

This project was undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy course of VITyarthi. As a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador, my role is to assist classmates in using the internet sensibly and productively. The project's goal is to create a useful portfolio that highlights key aspects of digital literacy, from safe internet usage to professional communication. The assignment's main goals are to assist students get more comfortable with digital tools, establish a professional online presence, and fully understand the significance of safe and moral online conduct. The objectives include a GitHub repository containing structured tasks, each aligned with a module of the course. These tasks cover infographic design, portfolio building, coding and collaboration platforms, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. The scenario highlights that appropriate engagement in the digital ecosystem is just as important to digital literacy as ability to use technology. It is our responsibility as ambassadors to make difficult digital ideas understandable for our classmates. This project therefore, combines creativity, technical exploration, and reflection, ensuring that the learning is both practical and impactful. By completing these tasks, I aim to contribute to a culture of safe, professional, and informed digital engagement among my peers.

<u>Task-1</u>: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I used Canva as my main design tool to create a one-page infographic that feels interesting and simple to follow by combining text, icons, and futuristic images. The design highlights three main aspects of digital literacy: its definition, email etiquette, and safe internet practices. I chose a simple, clean, modern layout to focus on the main information and make it easy to grasp and catch everyone's attention. The visuals—robots, laptops, and digital symbols—were meant to show how technology is part of our everyday lives and why being digitally literate is more than just knowing how to operate a computer. One interesting part of the process was deciding how much information to include. Digital literacy is such a broad concept, and I found it challenging to balance depth with simplicity. I realised that the key was to focus on what matters most to students: communicating effectively online, staying safe, and using digital tools responsibly. It was also fun experimenting with colour schemes that felt “techy” yet approachable.

However, I also found it slightly difficult to balance text and visuals—adding too much text made it crowded, while too little made it incomplete. Overall, this project helped me realise that digital literacy is not just about using technology, but about using it responsibly and effectively in daily life.

<u>Task 2</u>: Building My Student Digital Portfolio

For my digital portfolio, I chose to set up accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggl**e**. Each of these platforms serves a unique purpose in shaping my professional presence and learning journey.

GitHub is the central hub for coding projects and collaboration. I created a profile README that introduces my branch, year, and academic interests. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document coursework, share project repositories, and contribute to open-source initiatives.

LinkedI**n** is essential for networking and building a professional identity. I updated my education details and will gradually add skills, certifications, and internship experiences. My goal is to use LinkedIn to connect with peers, faculty, and industry professionals, while also staying updated on career opportunities.

Kaggle is a platform for data science practice and competitions. I set up my profile to explore datasets and participate in beginner-level challenges. In the coming years, I intend to use Kaggle to strengthen my analytical skills, collaborate on machine learning projects, and showcase my progress in data-driven problem solving.

Together, these platforms form the foundation of my digital presence, enabling me to learn, share, and grow throughout my B.Tech journey.

<u>Task 3</u>: Exploring Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, I created an account on HackerRank and completed the beginner-level challenge .This exercise helped me get familiar with the platform's coding environment and gave me a sense of how challenges are structured. HackerRank is a great way to practice programming skills, earn badges, and gradually build confidence in solving problems. Over time, I plan to use it to strengthen my fundamentals and prepare for technical interviews.

For the collaboration part, I used Google Forms. I designed a five-question quiz on Digital Literacy, including multiple-choice and short-answer formats. The linked Google Sheet allowed me to view responses in real time, which showed me how easily data can be collected and analyzed. This tool is especially useful for group projects, surveys, and academic activities where feedback from peers is important.

Together, these platforms highlight two sides of digital learning: individual skill-building through coding practice, and collective collaboration through cloud-based tools. Over the next four years, I plan to use HackerRank to track my coding progress and Google Forms to organize peer learning activities, making both tools integral to my academic journey.

<u>Task-4</u>: Reflection on Poor Digital Communication

One situation where poor digital communication created a serious problem was when a student posted a sarcastic remark about a professor in a public WhatsApp group. The intention was casual humor, but the message was misinterpreted as disrespectful and quickly spread among peers. Eventually, the professor became aware of it, and the student faced disciplinary action. This incident highlights how tone and context can easily be misunderstood in digital spaces, especially when communication lacks professionalism.

The problem could have been avoided if the student had chosen a private and respectful channel to express concerns or avoided sarcasm altogether in an academic context. Professional language, clarity of intent, and awareness of audience are crucial in digital communication. Unlike face-to-face interactions, online messages lack non-verbal cues and remain permanently recorded, which makes them more prone to misinterpretation. This situation reinforced the importance of being mindful of what we share online and ensuring that our digital communication reflects respect and responsibility.

Task-5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

During my research on UPI and online payment fraud, I was most surprised by how easily fraudsters exploit human psychology rather than technical loopholes. They rely on urgency, fear, or greed—convincing victims that they must act immediately to secure a refund, unlock an account, or claim a prize. What shocked me most was that even educated individuals, including college students and professionals, often fall victim simply because they do not pause to verify requests. The fact that entering a UPI PIN for a “refund” actually authorizes money to leave your account was an eye-opener.

I also realized how widespread these scams are in India, with thousands of cases reported each year despite awareness campaigns. This shows that vigilance must become a daily habit, not just occasional caution.

One personal habit I will change after this project is to slow down and critically evaluate every digital payment or suspicious message before responding. I will double-check UPI IDs, reject unsolicited “collect requests,” and never share sensitive details over calls or messages. By adopting this cautious approach, I can protect myself and also set an example for my peers, reinforcing the importance of digital safety in our everyday lives.

CONCLUSION

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and its importance in today's academic and professional environment. By completing the five tasks, I was able to explore different aspects such as creating visual content, building a digital portfolio, using online platforms, practising professional communication, and understanding cyber safety. Each task contributed to developing practical skills that go beyond theoretical knowledge.

Working on this project also helped me become more confident in using tools like GitHub, Canva, and Google Forms, while improving my ability to communicate effectively through emails and online platforms. The cybercrime module, in particular, made me more aware of online risks and the importance of safe digital practices.

Overall, this project was a valuable learning experience that highlighted how digital literacy is essential not just for academic success, but also for building a responsible and professional digital presence. It has encouraged me to continue improving my digital skills and use technology more effectively and responsibly in the future.